

# Lihai YANG (杨荔海)

Hong Kong, Kowloon Tong | Phone: (+852) 51783844 | Email: [lihaiyang2-c@my.cityu.edu.hk](mailto:lihaiyang2-c@my.cityu.edu.hk)

SSRN Author Page | Personal Website: <https://lihai-yang.github.io/>

## EDUCATION

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**Ph.D. in Finance, City University of Hong Kong** 2021-2027 (*expected*)

*Committee members:* Junbo Wang (Chair), Tao Li, Di Wu

**Visiting Ph.D., Stern School of Business, New York University** Aug 2024-May 2025

*Sponsor:* Yakov Amihud

**Master of Finance, Xiamen University** 2018-2021

*Advisor:* Zhenlong Zheng

**Bachelor of Management, Xiamen University** 2014-2018

*Major:* Financial Management

## RESEARCH INTERESTS

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Empirical Asset Pricing; Behavioral Finance; Derivatives; Corporate Bonds; Economic Linkages and Firm Network; News Media

## WORKING PAPERS (\*=PRESENTATION BY CO-AUTHORS)

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- [1] “[Cross-Bond Momentum Spillovers](#)” , with Junbo Wang and Di Wu  
*Conditionally Accepted at Journal of Financial and Quantitative Analysis*  
*Presentations:* 2023 Chinese Financial Annual Meeting; 2023 PolyU Fixed Income and Institutions Research Symposium (Ph.D. poster session); 2024 Conference of the International Association for Applied Econometrics
- [2] “[Peer Option Momentum](#)” , with Christopher S. Jones, Mehdi Khorram, Shuaiqi Li, Haitao Mo, and Yuanyi Zhang  
(Supersede an [earlier version](#) with Shuaiqi Li)  
*Presentations:* 2026 Canadian Derivatives Institute Conference on Derivatives (CDI)\*; 2026 FMA Annual Meeting\*; 2026 Southern Finance Association Annual Meeting (SFA)\*
- [3] “[Media Coverage, Volatility Overreaction, and Option Returns](#)” , solo-authored  
(A new merged version in progress with Jie Cao, Shuaiqi Li, Linjia Song, Ruijing Yang, and Xintong Zhan)  
*Presentations:* 2025 CityU International Finance Conference (Ph.D. poster session)
- [4] “[Does an Option-based Discount Rate Predict Stock Returns?](#)” , with Tao Li and Di Wu  
*Presentations:* 2023 China International Conference in Finance (CICF); 2023 Annual Conference of the Asia-Pacific Association of Derivatives (APAD); 2023 China Derivatives Youth Forum; 2022 Chinese Financial Annual Meeting; Seminar at City University of Hong Kong

- [5] “[Butterfly Implied Returns](#)” , with Di Wu  
*Presentations:* 30th Finance Forum\*; Seminar at Zhejiang University\*; Seminar at City University of Hong Kong\*
- [6] “Expected Return Bound for the Chinese Stock Market” (in Chinese: [中国股市的预期收益率界限](#)), with Wei Hu and Zhenlong Zheng  
*Presentations:* 2021 Chinese Financial Annual Meeting; Master degree dissertation at Xiamen University, 2021

## PUBLICATIONS

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- [1] “Variance Risk, Skewness Risk and Market Return Predictability” (in Chinese: [方差风险, 偏度风险与市场收益率的可预测性](#)), with Zhenlong Zheng and Rong Chen, **China Economic Quarterly** (经济学 (季刊)), 2022
- [2] “Bull Beta and Stock Returns” (in Chinese: [牛市贝塔与股票收益率](#)), with Zhenlong Zheng and Rong Chen, **Journal of Management Science in China** (管理科学学报), 2025

## OTHER RESEARCH EXPERIENCE

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**Research Assistant in City University of Hong Kong** *Sept 2025-Feb 2027*  
 research and departmental teaching assistant duties

**Research Assistant for Haitao Li (Cheung Kong Graduate School of Business)** *2020-2021*  
 construct the factor libraries of cross-sectional pricing factors in the Chinese stock market and test their performance

## TEACHING EXPERIENCE

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**Teaching Assistant for Wenji Xu (City University of Hong Kong)**  
 For undergraduate course of Industrial Organization *2022 Spring, 2023 Spring, 2024 Spring*  
 For undergraduate course of Microeconomics *2022 Fall, 2023 Fall*

**Teaching Assistant for Jun Cai (City University of Hong Kong)**  
 For undergraduate course of Advanced Corporate Finance *2026 Spring*

**Teaching Assistant for Jintao Du (City University of Hong Kong)**  
 For undergraduate course of Trading Room Workshop *2026 Fall*

## HONORS AND AWARDS

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### In City University of Hong Kong:

Best Summer Paper Award to Junior PhD Students *2023 Summer*  
 Outstanding Academic Performance Award *2022, 2023, 2024, 2025*  
 Research Tuition Scholarship *2022, 2023, 2024*  
 Postgraduate Studentship *2021-2025*

## SKILLS

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|---------------------------|----------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------------|
| <b>Programming Skills</b> | SAS, Python, STATA, MATLAB, LATEX                                                                                                |
| <b>U.S. Database</b>      | OptionMetrics, Trace Enhanced, WRDS Bond Return, Mergent FISD, eMAXX, CRSP, Compustat, IBES, RavenPack, Bloomberg, Google trends |
| <b>Chinese Database</b>   | CSMAR, WIND                                                                                                                      |
| <b>Languages</b>          | English (fluent), Mandarin (Native)                                                                                              |

## ADDITIONAL INFORMATION

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**Born:** 1997-01-27

**Hobby:** Traveling, Food, Soccer

## REFERENCES

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### **Junbo Wang**

Professor of Finance

Department of Economics and Finance

City University of Hong Kong

Email: [jwang2@cityu.edu.hk](mailto:jwang2@cityu.edu.hk)

[Personal website](#)

### **Christopher S. Jones**

Chair Professor of Finance and Business Economics

Marshall School of Business

University of Southern California

Email: [christopher.jones@marshall.usc.edu](mailto:christopher.jones@marshall.usc.edu)

[Personal website](#)

### **Shuaiqi Li**

Assistant Professor of Finance

Department of Economics and Finance

City University of Hong Kong

Email: [shuaiqli@cityu.edu.hk](mailto:shuaiqli@cityu.edu.hk)

[Personal website](#)

### **Di Wu**

Assistant Professor of Finance (Former)

City University of Hong Kong

Laboratory for AI-Powered Financial Technologies Limited

Email: [woodywu@cityu.edu.hk](mailto:woodywu@cityu.edu.hk)

[Personal website](#)

### **Zhenlong Zheng**

Professor of Finance

School of Management

Xiamen University

Email: [zllzheng@xmu.edu.cn](mailto:zllzheng@xmu.edu.cn)

[Personal website](#)

### **Rong Chen**

Professor of Finance

School of Management

Xiamen University

Email: [aronge@xmu.edu.cn](mailto:aronge@xmu.edu.cn)

[Personal website](#)